



# Parent Information

**Template.** Fill in everything in [ SQUARE BRACKETS ] and delete this line before sending.

## Ages 7–12 · 8 weeks · Starting [DATE]

Dear parents and caregivers,

The Kerala Cultural Club is starting a coding club for children aged 7 to 12 — Game Makers, the first class under our new KCC Code Club — and we'd love your child to join us.

Over eight weekly sessions, the children will learn the real foundations of programming — how to give a computer instructions, how to make decisions and repeat things, how to store information, and above all how to work out why something isn't doing what they expected. They will do all of this by building their own arcade game, which grows a little every week. On the last day, you're invited to come and watch them demo what they made.

No experience is needed. Most of them will never have written a line of code before, and that's exactly who this is for.

## The practical details

|                     |                                                                                                   |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ages</b>         | 7–12                                                                                              |
| <b>When</b>         | [DAY] afternoons, [TIME]–[TIME], starting [DATE]                                                  |
| <b>Where</b>        | [VENUE AND ADDRESS]                                                                               |
| <b>How long</b>     | 8 weekly sessions of 90 minutes                                                                   |
| <b>Cost</b>         | <b>\$40 for the whole term</b> — eight sessions, so \$5 a session. Payable before the first class |
| <b>Class size</b>   | [N] places, first come first served                                                               |
| <b>Last session</b> | [DATE] — the showcase. <b>Please come.</b>                                                        |

## What we use

We teach with [Scratch](#), a free visual programming language made by MIT and used in schools around the world. Children snap coloured blocks together instead of typing code, which means they spend their time thinking about ideas rather than fighting with punctuation. It runs in a web browser and it's completely free.

We'll create a Scratch account for your child through a club teacher account. We'll cover online safety in class, and we ask the children not to put personal details in their projects. Their work will be saved online so they can carry on at home.

## What your child needs to bring

- **A laptop.** We don't have club laptops for this first term, so this one is unavoidable — sorry. Any laptop from the last six or seven years is fine, and a Chromebook works too.

- Headphones, if they have some. Not essential.
- That's it. No books, nothing to install, nothing more to pay.

If not having a laptop is what's stopping you signing up, **please tell us anyway**. We can't promise anything, but we would much rather know and try to help than have you quietly not come.

### **What we'd love from you**

**Ask them about it.** Every week they'll have a small optional task to try at home — usually fifteen minutes, always something they can show off. There's no marking and nothing is chased. The single most useful thing you can do is let them show you what they built and be impressed, even when you have no idea what you're looking at. Especially then.

**Come to the showcase.** The last session is a demo evening, and it's the thing they'll remember.

### **A note on how we run it**

This is volunteer-run. There are always at least two adults in the room, and we keep the group small enough that every child gets help within a minute of putting their hand up. Nothing is graded, there are no tests, and we won't chase homework — the aim is that they finish the eight weeks wanting to carry on, not that they tick every box.

If your child misses a week, don't worry. We keep a saved copy of the project at every stage, so we can get them straight back up to speed.

The same goes for the fee. If it is difficult for your family, say so and we will sort it out quietly — we would far rather have your child in the room.

### **Registering**

[REGISTRATION LINK OR PROCESS]

Please also complete the consent and photo permission form before the first session — we can't start your child without it.

If you have questions, or if your child has any needs we should know about so we can support them properly, please get in touch. We'd much rather know in advance.

Warm regards,

**[NAME]** [ROLE], Kerala Cultural Club [EMAIL] · [PHONE]